



◁ BLACK RHINOCEROS

Slightly smaller and rounder than the white rhino, the black rhino (*Diceros bicornis*) is identified by its narrow, pointed lip.

More than **1,000 rhinos** were killed by poachers in South Africa in 2014

Group dynamics

White rhinos follow a complex system of social organization. Females and calves live in groups of five or six. Although the ranges of adult females overlap, there is little contact between the groups. The female gives birth to a single calf after a gestation of 16 months and the young stay with their mothers for two to three years. Adolescents form “friendships” or accompany cows that are without calves. Adult bulls, however, are solitary unless on the lookout for a breeding female.

They may tolerate one or two subordinate males close by—so long as they do not pose a challenge. Bulls mark their territories vigorously and stand horn-to-horn with intruding males, screaming defiance. It is safer for the weaker ones to back off than to turn tail, which invites a chase and heavy, damaging strikes from the fearsome horn. Adult white rhinos are effectively immune from attack by predators because of their huge size—humans are their only enemy—and healthy animals can live for around 45 years.

▽ LITTLE AND LARGE

Females are aggressively protective of their young, vulnerable calves, but chase them away after two to three years, before breeding again.

